to repeat themselves, but I calculated the total number of possible bridge hands and proved there were enough different hands to keep us busy for countless trillions of years without much chance of repetition.

He would say, "What are you worried about?"

I would say, "Suppose something happens to Gertrude while I'm gone."

He would say, "What could you do right now if something does?"

I would say, "Nothing."

"He would say, "Then f— it."

I couldn't quite make myself take that attitude, but it did lighten the tension a bit.

There was a problem about sleeping. Three soldiers were assigned to every upper and lower bunk—one in the upper and two in the lower. James, Upton, and I had one set of bunks, and we tossed coins, odd man taking the upper. Ed James won and climbed above.

Ed Upton seemed unconcerned, stripped to his underwear, got into the lower bunk near the window and, as nearly as I could make out, fell asleep at once. I stripped to my underwear, got in very cautiously, and tried to hold myself in such a way as to make no contact.

I got very little sleep on that train.

We got into Chicago at 3:30 p.m. on March 3 and had a five-hour layover. We seven got out, visited a USO, then trooped over to a bar. There we sang songs (we did that a lot on the train, too, between bridge games) and the other six drank. In particular, we did a soulful rendition of "The WhifTenpoof Song."

A fellow at the bar was so taken with Dylewski, in particular, that he gave him his card and urged him to come see him after he got out of the Army and there would be a job waiting for him.

Back on the train we passed through Iowa and Nebraska. I mailed letters in Omaha. We also made up parodies of popular songs, which we referred to as the "Ballads of the Battling Bastards of Bikini." Unfortunately, I don't remember a single parody. Not one.